Madilyn Tavares

Full Stack Developer
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Professional Summary

Full stack developer (PERN, Astro, Next, Typescript, Tailwind CSS) with 3+ years of development experience across web and games. Built and deployed full stack web apps and shipped game features used by thousands of players, including a multiplayer VR experience that tripled the game's daily active users. Comfortable with version control, APIs, and PostgreSQL.

Skills

- **Front-end:** Astro, React, Next, TypeScript, HTML, CSS, Tailwind
- **Back-end & Database:** Node, Express, PostgreSQL, DBeaver, Postbird
- **Tools & Processes:** Git, TortoiseGit, Command Line, Claude Code, Trello
- **Game Development:** Unity, C#, Photon Fusion
- **Soft Skills**: Adaptability, Clear Communication, Critical Thinking

Projects

Book Tracker | Live Site | GitHub | Next, Express, PostgreSQL, Tailwind

- Built and deployed a full-stack app where users organize books into "want-to-read", "reading", and "finished" lists
- Implemented user authorization and authentication using BetterAuth
- Designed the PostgreSQL schema to organize users and books
- Integrated the OpenLibrary API to fetch publicly available book data
- Built reading stats that show number of books read over the past week, month, and year
- Added a finish flow with star ratings, share buttons, and discussion questions that encourage deeper reflection

Comedian Website (Client Commission) | Live Site | Astro, Tailwind

- Designed, built, and deployed a website for a professional comedian as a client commission
- Integrated the Google Sheets API to pull in the comedian's upcoming shows and display them to users

Experience

Game Design Instructor

Game-U May 2026-Present

- Instruct students in **programming** and **3D modeling**, with lesson plans tailored to each student
- Report **monthly** to a supervisor regarding student progress and welfare
- **Step i**n for absent instructors and submit lesson recaps **on time**

Gameplay Developer

Engine Room VR June 2023-April 2026

- Shipped the viral "Fists of Fury" minigame that **tripled** the game's daily active users
- Built several game systems in **C# for Unity**, including a calorie tracker, boxer damage visuals, and a tutorial walkthrough
- Managed multiple branches of the project's **Git repository** with team members
- Triaged and resolved on average **8 bugs per week** using the project's Trello board
- Collaborated across disciplines to integrate **dozens of assets** into the project
- Overhauled **UI functionality and aesthetics** based on player feedback and internal testing
- Added multiplayer to the "Fists of Fury" minigame, keeping gameplay in sync among players
- Learned new skills as needed, including VR programming, multiplayer frameworks, and TypeScript

Academic Tutor

TutorMe Education June 2021-May 2023

- Tailored lesson plans for individual students, raising their average grades by **at least one letter grade**
- **Updated** parents regularly on their children's progress
- Maintained meticulous records of **10+ lessons** a week

Education

Bachelor of Game Development (B.S.) November 2020-March 2023

Full Sail University, Winter Park, FL

Certifications

Learn TypeScript September 2026

Codecademy

Full Stack Web Development July 2026

Codecademy

Learn Next.js May 2026
Codecademy
Learn the Command Line May 2026
Codecademy

Awards

Valedictorian March 2023
Full Sail University
Course Director's Award (Project & Portfolio VII) December 2022
Full Sail University
Course Director's Award (Programming II) February 2021
Full Sail University

Volunteer Work

Journalist May 2026-Present
Games for Love